Andy Cadotte

BIS 372

Delivery 2: Market Study of Third-Party Syllabus Management Tools

Matthew Morris, Jerome Salon, Deeksha Chandra, Shane Bresnahan

Project Background

- Each term, COB instructors are asked to submit course syllabi, a process currently managed by a single administrator, John Womack.
- The current system uses a mix of Microsoft Access, Salesforce, Qualtrics, Excel, and Box with multiple manual steps.
- Workflow includes pulling instructor-course data, sending email requests, collecting files via Qualtrics, renaming and converting files, and manually uploading them to Box.
- Limitations include excessive manual labor, lack of searchability in Box, error-prone file naming, and no automated organization or error-handling mechanisms.
- Project goal: analyze, critique, and improve the syllabus submission and storage process using business process design principles.

Why This Matters

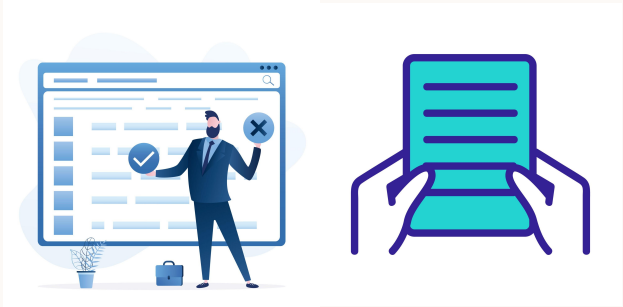
- Manual processing slows down syllabus availability and increases admin workload
- Box repository lacks search functionality and intuitive navigation
- Instructors receive limited guidance, leading to inconsistent file naming and uploads
- Students struggle to locate syllabi across courses and terms
- An improved process would reduce errors, save time, and improve access for all users

Requirements For a Solution

- Must support secure file collection from faculty
- Ability to link syllabi to specific courses and instructors
- Automated file naming and folder organization
- Enforce or convert files to PDF format
- Must be searchable by course, instructor, or term
- Should integrate with OSU tools (e.g., Box, Gmail, Drive)
- Needs to be FERPA compliant and scalable

Tools We Evaluated

- Google Workspace – Forms, Drive, and Apps Script for automation
- Dropbox – File requests and light automation features
- Box + Power Automate – Secure enterprise storage with workflow tools
- Qualtrics (Enhanced) – Survey logic-based collection already in use



Evaluation Matrix Overview

- Compared tools across 15 key criteria based on project goals
- Criteria included file collection, automation, organization, compliance, and ease of use
- Tools were scored as Fully Supported, Workaround Needed, Not Supported
- Matrix helped identify strengths, weaknesses, and best fit for OSU

#	Requirement	Google Workspace	Dropbox	Box + Needs Power Automate	Qualtrics
1	Syllabus File Collection	Fully Supported	Fully Supported	Fully Supported	Fully Supported
2	Instructor Course Association	Workaround Needed	Workaround Needed	Workaround Needed	Fully Supported
3	File Renaming/Metadata Tagging	Fully Supported	Workaround Needed	Fully Supported	Not supported
4	PDF Conversion Report	Workaround Needed	Not supported	Workaround Needed	Not supported

Gaps In Evaluation

- Some tools lacked full documentation or trial access
- File tagging and PDF conversion features were unclear in Dropbox
- Integration with OSU systems needs hands-on testing for Google and Box
- Faculty ease of use not fully tested without user feedback
- Further testing needed to confirm admin time savings

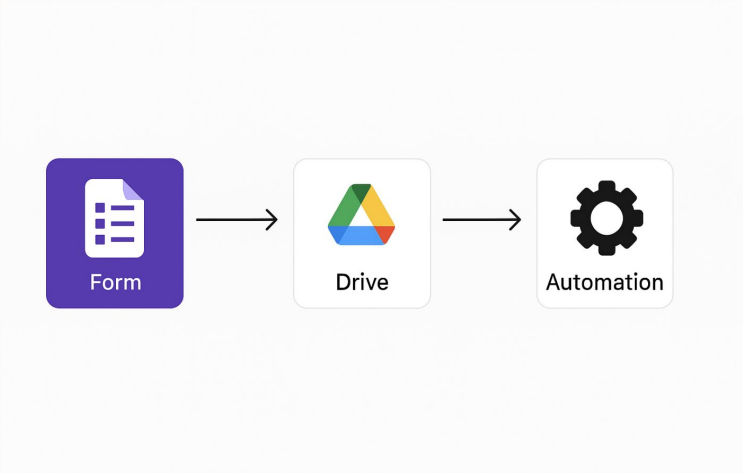
Requirement	Tools	Gap	Suggested Action
Cost/Licensing	Dropbox, Box	Education pricing details	Contact sales reps for quotes
PDF Conversion	Google, Box	Requires custom scripting	Test file automation via Apps Script
Search UX (Box)	Box	End user usability unclear	Coordinate with OSU IT
Reporting / Logging	Dropbox, Google	Log detail level not confirmed	Upload test files, export logs

Our Top 3 Recommendations

- 1st: Google Workspace – Strong on cost, OSU integration, ease of use, and automation
- 2nd: Box + Power Automate – Secure and structured, but more complex to configure
- 3rd: Qualtrics (Enhanced) – Familiar tool, but limited tagging and file handling

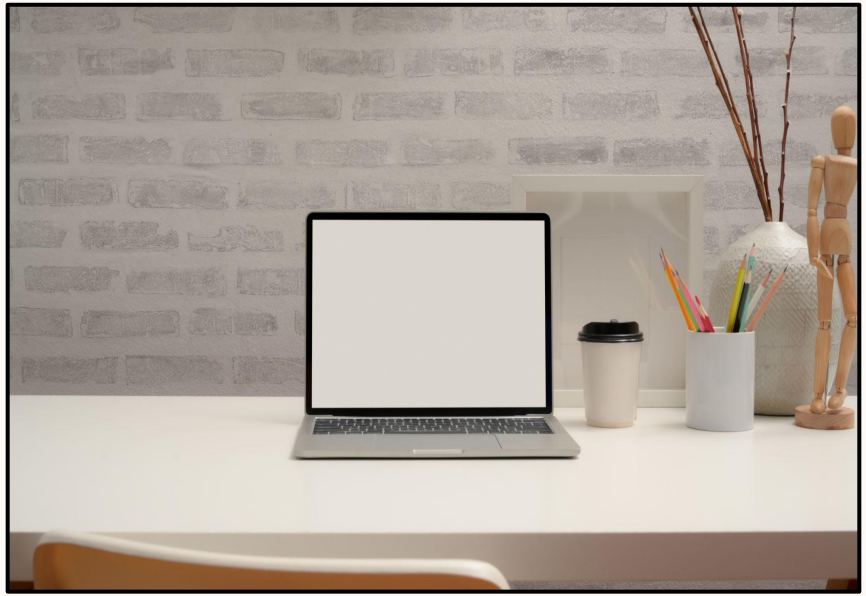
Google Workspace Implementation

- Instructors upload syllabi through a Google Form
- Files are auto stored in organized Google Drive folders by course and term
- Google Apps Script handles renaming, tagging, and confirmation emails
- Admins can monitor uploads and trigger reminders automatically



Benefits of Our Recommended Solution

- Saves time for COB administrators
- Reduces manual steps and human error
- Enables faster, more consistent uploads
- Improves search and access for students and faculty
- Scales easily as course volume grows

Conclusion

- Google Workspace is the best fit for improving the syllabus process
- Meets key goals: automation, cost efficiency, searchability, and ease of use
- Supports OSU tools and requires minimal training for instructors
- Ready for next steps: pilot program, automation testing, and stakeholder feedback